

# **MKT 774: Market and Customer Focus**

## **EMBA 60**

**January to March 2025**

### **Professors**

Robyn LeBoeuf, PhD

Joyce and Chauncy Buchheit Distinguished Professor in Marketing

Pronouns: she/her

Office: Bauer Hall 422

Phone: 352.281.9421 (mobile)

Email: [leboeuf@wustl.edu](mailto:leboeuf@wustl.edu)

Stephen Nowlis, PhD

August A. Busch Jr. Distinguished Professor in Marketing

Pronouns: he/him

Office: Knight Hall 445

Phone: 314.935.5113 (office)

314.813.8163 (mobile)

Email: [nowlis@wustl.edu](mailto:nowlis@wustl.edu)

### **Course Description**

We will study marketing and marketing management. According to the American Marketing Association, marketing is “the activity, set of institutions, and processes for creating, communicating, delivering, and exchanging offerings that have value for customers, clients, partners, and society at large.” More colloquially, marketing is about creating value for customers while also creating value for your firm.

Marketing management is concerned with selecting the target market (where to compete) and designing the marketing program (how to compete) for a product, brand, or service, or for a business or firm at large. Whether you work in marketing or not, this class will provide insights to help you better manage your business. After all, at the end of the day, marketing is about understanding customers and building revenue, which are key concerns in any business. The principles in this class are applicable across contexts, including business-to-business, business-to-consumer, government agencies, and non-profits.

This course should give you the following core competencies:

1. How to conduct market research and use this research to connect with your customers and make better business decisions.
2. How to analyze market segments and select a segment to target.
3. How to create a positioning statement.
4. How to build and manage brand equity.
5. How to use marketing to enhance the success of new products.
6. How to calculate and grow customer lifetime value.
7. How to use the 4 P's (promotion, price, place, and product) to increase profitability.
8. How to develop a marketing plan.

### **Class Organization and Instruction Methods**

This course will provide you with a mix of: (i) analytical abilities and tools, (ii) real-world applications, and (iii) frameworks to use in different situations. Much of the learning will occur by participation. In particular, we will rely heavily, but not exclusively, on the case method. Case studies provide one of the major vehicles for applying marketing concepts and theories. As you may have learned in previous courses, effective case analysis requires critical evaluation (including interpretation) of both facts and logic. Cases also require that you be prepared and actively involved in class discussions.

Additionally, you will complete a marketing plan. This exercise will provide another opportunity for you to critically analyze marketing situations and exercise your decision-making skills.

### **Course Materials**

- **Course Packet (required):** The course packet primarily includes cases. Please read the assigned cases before each class. It is very important to be prepared. We will cold call people. Our intention in doing so is not to play "gotcha," but rather to make sure that we get a mix of perspectives on every case.
- **Textbook (recommended but not required):** *Strategic Marketing Management* by Chernev (2019), 10<sup>th</sup> edition. We recommend that you read the textbook, especially if you are new to marketing. You may find that certain chapters are of more interest to you than others, so feel free to pay more attention to those chapters. If you are already familiar with certain concepts, then you might want to just skim those chapters.
- **Marketing Plan Handbook (recommended but not required):** *The Marketing Plan Handbook* by Chernev (2020), 6<sup>th</sup> edition. A marketing plan is a big part of this class. This book will help you complete your plan.
- **Canvas:** We will post files, lecture slides, and other course-related material on Canvas.

## Assignments

### 1. Marketing Plan (Ongoing Team Assignment, Completed Outside of Class)

A marketing plan is a written document that summarizes what you have learned about the marketplace and specifies how your firm plans to reach its marketing objectives. A marketing plan provides direction and focus for a new or existing brand, new or existing product, new or existing service, or new or existing company. Marketing plans are used by B2B firms, B2C firms, entrepreneurs (as a part of the full business plan), government agencies, and nonprofits.

The focus of this marketing plan will be on a new product or service that you create. This will need to be a truly new product or service that you come up with. It could be related to something your company is already doing, or it could be completely unrelated, but it needs to be a new idea (in other words, not something your company is already working on).

First, your team will need to decide on the focus of the marketing plan. Please think of a new product/service that you can offer. Please be prepared to briefly discuss the focus of your marketing plan during class in session 3.

Next, take a look at *The Marketing Plan Handbook* to help guide you on what you need to include in your marketing plan. Your job is to write a marketing plan that is at most 25 pages of double-spaced text (plus exhibits and tables if you like). Please submit this as a paper, not as a PowerPoint presentation.

Your plan will be stronger if you are able to include some marketing research or customer insights (ideally, both secondary research or existing data, and primary research, where you collect your own data). This can help you explore the viability of the new product or service that you have in mind. For example, if you have an idea for a new app, what research supports the idea of launching it? What would customers or clients like about it, and how can it be profitable?

Some points you should consider when writing up your marketing plan: (1) Is the plan specific? (2) Is the plan realistic? (3) Is the plan complete? (4) Is the plan based on sound evidence and analysis?

You will grade each member of your team, and your grade will be adjusted depending on your team's assessment of your performance. You will also present your plan to the class on the last day of class.

For more information on the marketing plan, please refer to the first lecture, where we have notes on what you should and should not include in your plan. Please note that you need not include anything on Implementation and Controls.

## **2. Individual Case Write-Ups (Individual Assignments, Completed Outside of Class)**

We suggest that you read the assigned cases twice at home. The first read can be done quickly to obtain a “big picture” appreciation of the case situation. The second read should be slow and thorough, involving mark-ups and annotations, to obtain a good grasp of the case fundamentals and details. This will enable you to be well-prepared to meaningfully contribute to the case discussion. You will then need to answer the case questions from the section titled, “Individual Case Write-Ups: Assigned Case Questions” (toward the end of the syllabus). These are to be completed individually (NOT a team effort). Your answers will be checked for plagiarism. Please upload your assignment to Canvas before the associated class session.

## **3. Team Breakout Assignments (Team Assignments, Completed During Class)**

Instructions for each breakout assignment will be given in class. The breakout tasks generally involve developing a solution to a case problem based on a healthy debate among team members regarding the pros and cons of alternative solutions. We encourage each team to draw on the unique expertise, as well as individual case preparation, of each of its team members during the breakout session. This will lead to a richer analysis of the case.

## **4. In-Class Contribution (Individual Assignment)**

You are neither expected to have all the right answers nor to dominate every discussion. However, you are required to be prepared and contribute regularly to our discussions, as learning depends heavily upon thorough and lively participation. The primary emphasis should be on quality participation, not quantity. The quality of participation, as reflected in careful reading of cases and assigned material, thoughtful reflection, and clear and concise comments, is extremely important. However, one cannot make quality contributions without some quantity. You are expected to be prepared for, and actively involved in, every class. Since we will call on students even when their hands are not raised, please let us know before the start of class if some emergency has made it impossible for you to be prepared adequately for that class.

Your participation should demonstrate careful preparation of cases and readings, clear and concise comments and recommendations, and convincing analysis to support your recommendations. The quality of the entire class discussion will depend on how well prepared you are and how willing you are to share the results of your preparation with the class. It is also important that your comments fit into and build on previous comments. This requires that we all listen carefully to each other.

Class contribution will be assessed based on *quality and consistency of effort*. If you want, you can ascertain the adequacy of your contribution by checking with us. However, careful self-monitoring using the following criteria may be useful:

1. Do your comments generate discussion, or do they tend to be ignored by others?
2. Do others appear confused when you make a point?
3. Are others left with a “so-what” feeling, or do you reach a conclusion that is clearly understood and appreciated?

4. Do your comments build on evidence from the assignment, or do they just relay what everyone already knows?
5. Are you able to clarify important aspects of previous comments and relate them to the problems and topics under discussion?
6. Do your comments distinguish among different kinds of data, facts, opinions, beliefs, and theories in their construction?

We should all try to make the classroom atmosphere as congenial and respectful as possible to assist all of our colleagues in participating. This does not mean that you must agree with every comment offered by your classmates. It is ok to disagree. Students are also encouraged to connect outside of class to discuss cases and material before the scheduled class. This may help you in the preparation of material and give you more confidence when contributing in class.

Finally, please understand that, although we want a rich classroom discussion, from time to time it may be necessary for us to keep the discussion moving. (Meaning: Sometimes we cannot call on everyone who has raised their hand. Please don't take it personally when we move the conversation along in the interest of time.)

### **Grading**

|                               |                                                      |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| In-class contribution         | 25 % (Read the cases before class and come prepared) |
| Marketing plan written report | 25 % (Team project) <sup>1</sup>                     |
| Marketing plan presentation   | 10 % (Team project, last day of class)               |
| Individual case write-ups     | 20 % (5 write-ups, each worth 4%)                    |
| Team breakout assignments     | 20 % (5 assignments, each worth 4%)                  |

|              |             |
|--------------|-------------|
| <b>TOTAL</b> | <b>100%</b> |
|--------------|-------------|

### **Class Policies**

Please display your name card (or, if you lost it, just make a new one). We do our best to learn everyone's name as quickly as possible, but this is a big help in the meantime. If you attend via Zoom, please make sure your name is correctly displayed.

Please do not come to class late or leave early. Of course, we understand that there are special circumstances that can make this necessary; if this happens, please let us know ahead of time.

Finally, please raise your hand before you speak. Some of you are more comfortable than others with sharing your ideas. Hand-raising gives us a chance to call on students who may not be quite as vocal or may take an extra moment to gather their thoughts. These policies are meant to create a stimulating, respectful environment, where each of you feels comfortable, and where we challenge each other to come up with the best solutions.

---

<sup>1</sup> Your grade may be adjusted based on the evaluations of your peers.

## **Academic Integrity**

Academic integrity is important. We take it seriously. We hope and expect that you do, too. We will not tolerate plagiarism, unauthorized collaborations, data fabrication, or any other academic integrity violations. You commit plagiarism by taking someone else's ideas, words, or other products and presenting them as your own. You can avoid plagiarism by using proper methods of documentation and acknowledgement. Under no circumstance is it permissible to use the work of prior Olin students or students in other MBA programs when completing an assignment. Your work will be checked for plagiarism on Canvas, so please make sure your work is unique.

Put simply, we expect that all work submitted in this class is your own. We also expect that you will cite the ideas of others when you use them. If you use an AI tool to help you with part of an assignment, it is very important that you cite the part of the assignment that the tool created. But, it is not ok to use an AI tool to complete the entire assignment. If you do not cite the AI tool, that also will be considered a case of plagiarism.

Please refer to the Olin Business School's publication, *Integrity Matters*, for specific responsibilities, guidelines, and procedures regarding academic integrity.

## **About Your Professors**

Robyn LeBoeuf is the Joyce and Chauncy Buchheit Distinguished Professor in Marketing and vice dean of faculty and research at the Olin Business School at Washington University. She has taught in Olin's BSBA, MBA, PMBA, EMBA, and PhD programs. Her teaching awards include receiving the Emerson Excellence in Teaching Award and being named to the Poets & Quants list of Top 50 Undergraduate Business Professors Worldwide. She received her PhD in psychology at Princeton University, and her research focuses on consumer behavior and biases in human judgment and decision making. She has published articles in a wide variety of psychology and marketing journals and is an associate editor at *Management Science*. Her research awards include receiving the Hillel Einhorn New Investigator Award and being named to the American Marketing Association list of the top 50 most productive authors in the premier marketing journals.

Dr. Stephen Nowlis is the August A. Busch Jr. Distinguished Professor of Marketing, and former chair of the marketing area. He teaches marketing management to PMBA and EMBA students, and has taught brand management to MBA and PMBA students. He also teaches marketing management and consumer behavior to PhD students, and acts as an expert witness in cases involving issues such as trademark infringement, deceptive advertising, and class action certification. He received his BA in economics from Stanford University, and MBA and PhD from the University of California at Berkeley. His research focuses on consumer behavior, branding, and consumer judgment and decision making.

## Detailed Course Outline

|                  |                                            |                                                                         |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Session 1</b> | <b>January 16</b><br><b>8:00am-12:30pm</b> | <b>Connecting with your customers</b><br><b>Professor Robyn LeBoeuf</b> |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|

### Topics Covered:

- Overview of marketing
- How to successfully segment, target, and position your offering
- How to develop a marketing plan

### Required Readings:

- Does Mattel's Iconic Barbie Doll Need a Makeover? (case)
- DayTwo: Going to Market with Gut Microbiome (case)

### Recommended Readings:

- *Strategic Marketing Management* textbook, chapters 1-3
- *Marketing Plan Handbook*, chapters 1-4

### Assignment Due:

- Required Readings + **Individual writeup of the Barbie case (see the questions below)**

|                  |                                            |                                                                            |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Session 2</b> | <b>January 17</b><br><b>8:00am-12:30pm</b> | <b>Profiting from marketing research</b><br><b>Professor Robyn LeBoeuf</b> |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|

### Topic Covered:

- How to understand and profit from marketing research

### Required Readings:

- Wrigley's Eclipse Gum: Managing Brand Adolescence (case)
- Introducing New Coke (case)

### Recommended Readings:

- *Strategic Marketing Management* textbook, chapters 4-6

### Assignment Due:

- Required readings + **Individual writeup of the Wrigley's Eclipse Gum case (see the questions below)**

|                  |                                      |                                                           |
|------------------|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Session 3</b> | <b>January 18<br/>8:00am-12:30pm</b> | <b>Building strong brands<br/>Professor Robyn LeBoeuf</b> |
|------------------|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|

Topic Covered:

- How to manage and build strong brands

Required Readings:

- Dove: Evolution of a Brand (case)
- Old Spice: Repeating Success in the Face of Competitive Threat (case)

Recommended Readings:

- *Strategic Marketing Management* textbook, chapters 7-9

Assignment Due:

- **Please be prepared to describe in class the focus of your marketing plan**
- Required readings + **Individual writeup of the Dove case (see the questions below)**

|                  |                                   |                                                                       |
|------------------|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Session 4</b> | <b>March 13<br/>1:30pm–6:00pm</b> | <b>Marketing and new product success<br/>Professor Stephen Nowlis</b> |
|------------------|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|

Topic Covered:

- How to market and develop new products and services

Required Readings:

- TruEarth Healthy Foods: Market Research for a New Product Introduction (case)
- 21Seeds: Taking Shots at Breakout Growth (case)

Recommended Readings:

- *Strategic Marketing Management* textbook, chapters 14-16

Assignment Due:

- Required readings + **Individual writeup of the 21Seeds case (see the questions below)**



**Session 5****March 14  
1:30pm–6:00pm****Managing customer relationships and  
customer lifetime value  
Professor Stephen Nowlis**Topics Covered:

- How to manage your customers
- How to measure customer lifetime value
- Important marketing metrics

Required Readings:

- Rosewood Hotels and Resorts (case)
- Planter's Nuts (case)

Recommended Readings:

- *Strategic Marketing Management* textbook, chapters 10-11

Assignment Due:

- Required readings + **Individual writeup of the Planter's Nuts case (see the questions below)**

**Session 6****March 15  
1:30pm–6:00pm****Communicating with your customers  
Professor Stephen Nowlis**Topic Covered:

- How to communicate your message

Required Reading:

- Can 3G Capital Make Burger King Cool Again? (case)

Recommended Readings:

- *Strategic Marketing Management* textbook, chapters 12-13

Assignment Due:

- Required reading (no case writeup for today, but please read the case anyway)
- **Written marketing plan and marketing plan presentations due today**

## Individual Case Write-Ups: Assigned Case Questions

Please answer the following questions on an individual basis (without consulting classmates or sources other than the class readings) and upload your answers to Canvas by the beginning of each class session. The submission should be no longer than 2 pages (single-spaced, 12-point font) in length. For each session, read all the assigned readings (even if there are no assigned questions about the case) before class.

### A. Does Mattel's Iconic Barbie Doll Need a Makeover?

1. What are the main issues that Barbie (the brand) is facing at the time of the case?
2. What is your analysis of Mattel's repositioning efforts, including its new advertisements and new products (as described in the case)?

### B. Wrigley's Eclipse Gum: Managing Brand Adolescence

1. What are the potential problems with Eclipse gum at the time of the case?
2. For each of the potential problems that you outlined, what information would enable you to verify that it was the reason for Eclipse's underperformance?

### C. Dove: Evolution of a Brand

1. How did Dove's positioning change from the 1950s to when the case was written?
2. Spend some time searching to see what people are saying about Dove today. What is your sense of the meaning of the brand in consumers' eyes?

### D. 21Seeds

1. How did 21Seeds become such a successful brand in such a short time? What were the sources of 21Seeds' value to consumers and the firm?
2. Of the various options to grow 21Seeds – product innovations, distribution opportunities, and evolving the brand focus – which do you believe Diageo should prioritize at this stage? Why?

### E. Planter's Nuts

What insights (interpretations of the data) do you gather from Tables 1-6 and from the Positioning Statement (the information shown in the tables between Tables 5 and 6)?

## **Appendix**

### **Olin and WashU Policies and Resources**

#### **Olin's Pillars of Excellence:**

The pillars in bold are the ones most applicable to this course.

Olin's students will:

1. **Embody a values-based and data-driven ethos in their approach to all business situations.**
2. Understand the global opportunities and challenges facing businesses.
3. **Engage with business issues through the application of experiential knowledge, in addition to the rigorous technical skills acquired in the classroom.**
4. Pursue world-changing initiatives with an entrepreneurial and innovative mindset and skillset.

#### **University-Wide Policies:**

##### **Reporting Sexual Assault and Harassment**

If a student discusses or discloses an instance of sexual assault, sex discrimination, sexual harassment, dating violence, domestic violence or stalking, or if a faculty member otherwise observes or becomes aware of such an allegation, the faculty member will keep the information as private as possible, but as a faculty member of Washington University, they are required to immediately report it to the Department Chair or Dean or directly to the Gender Equity and Title IX Compliance Office at (314) 935-3393 or [titlix@wustl.edu](mailto:titlix@wustl.edu). They will also offer available resources, including confidential support resources through the Relationship and Sexual Violence Prevention ([RSVP](#)) at 314-935-3445. Additionally, you can report incidents or complaints to the Office of Student Conduct and Community Standards or by contacting WUPD at (314) 935-5555 or your local law enforcement agency. See: [Gender Equity and Title IX Compliance Office](#)

##### **Disability Resources**

WashU supports the right of all enrolled students to an equitable educational opportunity and strives to create an inclusive learning environment. In the event the physical or online environment results in barriers to the inclusion of a student due to a disability, they should notify the instructor as soon as possible.

Disabled students requiring adjustments to equitably complete expectations in this course should contact WashU's Disability Resources (DR) and engage in a process for determining and communicating reasonable accommodations. Because accommodations are not applied retroactively, DR recommends initiating requests prior to, or at the beginning of, the academic term to avoid delays in accessing accommodations once classes begin. Once established, responsibility for disability-related accommodations and access is shared by Disability Resources, faculty, and the student. Disability Resources: [www.disability.wustl.edu](http://www.disability.wustl.edu); 314-935-5970

##### **Statement on Military Service Leave**

Washington University recognizes that students serving in the U.S. Armed Forces and their family members may encounter situations where military service forces them to withdraw from a course of study, sometimes with little notice. Students may contact the Office of Military and Veteran Services at (314) 935-2609 or [veterans@wustl.edu](mailto:veterans@wustl.edu) and their academic dean for guidance and assistance. See: <https://veterans.wustl.edu/policies/policy-for-military-students/>.

### **Preferred Name and Personal Pronouns**

WashU recognizes that many students prefer to use names other than their legal ones to identify themselves. In addition, in order to affirm each person's gender identity and lived experiences, it is important that we ask and check in with others about pronouns. This simple effort can make a profound difference in a person's experience of safety, respect, and support. See: [Pronouns Information](#) and [Preferred Name](#).

### **Emergency Preparedness**

Before an emergency, familiarize yourself with the building(s) that you frequent. Know the layout, including exit locations, stairwells and the Emergency Assembly Point (EAP). Review the "Quick Guide for Emergencies" found near the door in many classrooms and main lobby areas of buildings for specific emergency information and instructions. For additional Information and EAP maps, visit <https://emergency.wustl.edu/>. To ensure that you receive emergency notifications, make sure your information and cell phone number is updated in SIS, and/or download the [WashU Safe app](#) and enable notifications.

To report an emergency:

Danforth Campus: (314) 935-5555

School of Medicine Campus: (314) 362-4357

North/West/South and Off Campus: 911 then (314) 935-5555

### **Academic Integrity**

Effective learning, teaching and research all depend upon the ability of members of the academic community to trust one another and to trust the integrity of work that is submitted for academic credit or conducted in the wider arena of scholarly research. Such an atmosphere of mutual trust fosters the free exchange of ideas and enables all members of the community to achieve their highest potential.

In all academic work, the ideas and contributions of others (including generative artificial intelligence) must be appropriately acknowledged and work that is presented as original must be, in fact, original. Faculty, students and administrative staff all share the responsibility of ensuring the honesty and fairness of the intellectual environment at Washington University in St. Louis.

For additional details on the university-wide Undergraduate Academic Integrity policy, please see: <https://wustl.edu/about/compliance-policies/academic-policies/undergraduate-student-academic-integrity-policy/>

Academic integrity is a serious offense that may lead to warning, suspension, or expulsion from the University. All instances of academic integrity allegations will be reported to Academic Integrity in the Office of the Provost, who will hold an initial meeting and then determine next steps with the student. For more information on the academic integrity policy, procedures, frequently asked questions, and who to contact, visit [Academic Integrity in the Office of the Provost](#). The academic integrity policy, process, and information listed there applies to undergraduate students enrolled in all Schools and programs and master's level students in the McKelvey School of Engineering, the Sam Fox School of Design and Visual Arts, and the School of Continuing and Professional Studies. For all other programs, please see the [Contacts](#) page.

In all cases of academic integrity violations, the instructor shall make an academic judgment about the student's grade on that work and in that course, which shall not be considered a sanction for prohibited conduct under this policy.

### **Turnitin**

In taking this course, students may be expected to submit papers and assignments through Turnitin for detection of potential plagiarism and other academic integrity concerns. If students do not have an account with Turnitin and/or do not utilize Turnitin when submitting their papers and assignments, the instructor may upload your paper or assignment to Turnitin for processing and review.

### **Religious Holidays**

As home to students, faculty, and staff of all the world's major religions and as a non-sectarian institution, Washington University in St. Louis values the rich diversity of spiritual expression and practice found on campus. It is therefore the policy of the university that students who miss class, assignments, or exams to observe a religious holiday should be accommodated. To ensure that accommodations may be made, students who plan to miss class for a religious holiday must inform their instructors in writing before the end of the third week of class, or as soon as possible if the holiday occurs during the first three weeks of the semester. Instructors should inform students on their syllabus and/or at the start of the class how they would like students to notify them of any accommodation needs related to religious observance. The university's Religious Holiday Class Absence Policy can be found [here](#).

The [Office of Religious, Spiritual and Ethical Life](#) maintains a [calendar](#) of many religious holidays observed by the WashU community.

### **Unauthorized Recording and Distribution of Classroom Activities and Course Materials**

Except as otherwise expressly authorized by the instructor or the university, students may not record, stream, reproduce, display, publish or further distribute any classroom activities or course materials. This includes lectures, class discussions, advising meetings, office hours, assessments, problems, answers, presentations, slides, screenshots or other materials presented as part of the course. If a student with a disability wishes to request the use of assistive technology as a reasonable accommodation, the student must first contact the Office of Disability Resources to seek approval. If recording is permitted, unauthorized use or distribution of recordings is also prohibited.

### **COVID-19 Health and Safety Protocols**

Students experiencing symptoms consistent with COVID-19 or concerned about a possible exposure should contact Habib Health and Wellness Center (314-935-6666) to arrange for testing as indicated. If a student tests positive for Covid-19, they will receive a letter with instructions about any necessary isolation that they can share with their instructors. Any accommodation needs for COVID-related absence not covered in an instructor's standard course policies should be discussed between the student and instructor.

While on campus, it is imperative that students follow all public health guidelines established to reduce the risk of COVID-19 transmission within our community.

**Masking:** Masking remains a valuable tool in the mitigation of COVID-19, particularly in light of new and emerging variants. Students and instructors are encouraged to treat requests to mask with care and consideration, keeping in mind that some individuals may be at a higher risk, caring for others at a higher

risk, or feeling less comfortable in a mask-optional environment. Based on monitoring of regional and campus conditions, a mask requirement may be implemented as needed.

Students with disabilities for whom masked instructors or classmates create a communication barrier are encouraged to contact Disability Resources ([www.disability.wustl.edu](http://www.disability.wustl.edu)) or talk to their instructor for assistance in determining reasonable adjustments. Adjustments may involve amplification devices, captioning, or clear masks but will not allow for the disregard of mask policies should a requirement be in place.

## **Resources for Students**

### **Confidential Resources for Instances of Sexual Assault, Sex Discrimination, Sexual Harassment, Dating Violence, Domestic Violence, or Stalking**

The University is committed to offering reasonable academic accommodations (e.g. a no-contact order, course changes) to students who are victims of relationship or sexual violence, regardless of whether they seek a formal investigation or criminal charges. If a student needs to explore options for medical care, other services, or reporting, or would like to receive individual counseling services, there are free, confidential support resources and professional counseling services available through the Relationship and Sexual Violence Prevention (RSVP) Center. If you need to request such accommodations, please contact RSVP to schedule an appointment with a confidential and licensed counselor. Although information shared with counselors is confidential, requests for accommodations will be coordinated with the appropriate University administrators and faculty. The RSVP Center is located in Seigle Hall, Suite 435, and can be reached at [rsvpcenter@wustl.edu](mailto:rsvpcenter@wustl.edu) or (314) 935-3445. For after-hours emergency response services, call the Sexual Assault and Rape Anonymous Helpline (SARAH) at (314) 935-8080 or call 314-935-6666 or (314) 935-5555 and ask to speak with an RSVP Counselor on call. See: [RSVP Center](#).

### **Bias Reporting and Support System (BRSS)**

The University has a non-punitive process through which students, faculty, staff, and community members who have experienced or witnessed incidents of bias, prejudice, or discrimination against a student can report their experiences to the University's [Bias Report and Support System \(BRSS\)](#) team.

### **Center for Career Engagement (CCE)**

The Center for Career Engagement provides one-on-one coaching, resources, programs and events to support the lifelong career success of all students and alumni. In addition to having your resume reviewed or fine-tuning your interviewing skills, the CCE invites you to work with us as partners at every stage of your career development as you reflect, learn and experiment. Our Certified Career Management Coaches will listen, ask questions, and provide resources to help you understand yourself, envision possibilities, prepare, search and apply, and engage in your career development.

You can select a career coach based on availability and alignment with one of our industry-aligned career communities, or you can choose a coach in the Career Exploration community. To make an appointment:

1. Log in to [Handshake](#)
2. Click Career Center (left side tool bar)
3. Click Appointments.

The CCE is conveniently located in the Danforth University Center, Suite 110 with several additional office spaces across campus in Knight Hall 210, Bauer Hall 250, Steinberg Hall and Brown Hall.

### **Counseling and Psychological Services**

The Center for Counseling and Psychological Services' professional staff members work with students to resolve personal and interpersonal difficulties, many of which can affect a student's academic experience. These include conflicts with or worry about friends or family, concerns about eating or drinking patterns, and feelings of anxiety, depression, and thoughts of suicide. Individual, Conjoint, and Group therapy are all provided in addition to referrals for off-campus support. Information can be found on the [CCPS webpage](#).

The Division of Student Affairs also offers a telehealth program to students called [TimelyCare](#). While students are encouraged to visit CCPS during business hours, this additional service also provides after-hours access to medical care and 24/7 access to mental telehealth care across the United States, with no cost at the time of the visit. 12 counseling visits are provided at no charge as well as a limited number of psychiatry appointments. Students who pay the Health and Wellness fee are eligible for this service.

Additionally, see the mental health services offered through the [RSVP Center](#).

### **WashU Cares**

WashU Cares specializes providing referrals and resources, both on, and off campus for mental health, medical health, financial and academic resources by using supportive case management. WashU Cares also receives reports on students who may need help connecting to resources or whom a campus partner is concerned about. If you are concerned about a student or yourself, you can file a report here: <https://washucares.wustl.edu/>.

### **The Writing Center**

The Writing Center offers free writing support to all Washington University undergraduate and graduate students. Staff members will work with students on any kind of writing project, including essays, writing assignments, personal statements, theses, and dissertations. They can help at any stage of the process, including brainstorming, developing and clarifying an argument, organizing evidence, or improving style. Instead of simply editing or proofreading papers, the tutors will ask questions and have a conversation with the writer about their ideas and reasoning, allowing for a higher order revision of the work. They will also spend some time looking at sentence level patterns to teach students to edit their own work.

The Center is located in Mallinckrodt, and appointments are available days and evenings Sunday through Friday. Office staff hours are Monday through Friday 10:00am to 4:00pm. Students are seen primarily by appointment, with walk-ins accepted as the schedule allows. They also have dedicated walk-in hours for undergraduates on Tuesday and Wednesday afternoons. Both in-person and online appointments are available. To make an appointment, go to [writingcenter.wustl.edu](http://writingcenter.wustl.edu). Email: [writing@wustl.edu](mailto:writing@wustl.edu).

### **The Learning Center**

The Learning Center provides [peer-led support programs](#), including course-specific mentoring and academic skills coaching (study and test-taking strategies, time management, etc.), that enhance undergraduate students' academic progress. Contact them at [learningcenter@wustl.edu](mailto:learningcenter@wustl.edu) or visit [ctl.wustl.edu/learningcenter](http://ctl.wustl.edu/learningcenter) to find out what support they may offer for your classes.

### **Center for Diversity and Inclusion (CDI)**

The Center for Diversity and Inclusion (CDI) supports and advocates for all undergraduate, graduate, and professional school students, especially from underrepresented and/or marginalized populations, collaborates with campus and community partners, and promotes dialogue and social change to cultivate

and foster a supportive campus climate for students of all backgrounds, cultures, and identities. Additional Diversity and Inclusion information can be found at <https://diversityinclusion.wustl.edu/>. The CDI consists of the following offices and is physically located in the Danforth University Center (DUC) Suite 150 and the Women's Building Room 102.

- Cross-Cultural Connections (CCxN) – DUC 150
- Dialogue across Difference (DxD) – DUC 150
- Office for International Student Engagement (OISE) – Women's Building 102
- Office for Religious, Spiritual and Ethical Life (ORSEL) – DUC 150
- Spectrum Office (LGBTQIA+ Support) – DUC 150

### **Gephardt Institute**

Students play an essential role in a vibrant and functioning democracy! In addition to the November General Elections, state and local elections take place throughout the year and have a direct impact on our communities. You can register to vote, request an absentee ballot, confirm your polling location, and get Election Day reminders at <http://wustl.turbovote.org> for any of the 50 states and Washington D.C. WashU students are considered Missouri residents, and eligible student voters can register to vote in the state of Missouri or their home state.

**To vote in Missouri, you will need a photo ID issued by the state of Missouri (e.g., driver's license or state ID) or a photo ID issued by the United States government (e.g., passport).** More information about voter identification in Missouri can be found at <https://www.sos.mo.gov/voterid>.

If you are ineligible to vote, you can participate by encouraging your friends to register and vote, engaging your peers in local issues, and taking part in other civic and community engagement activities. For more resources on voting and other civic and community engagement opportunities, please visit <http://vote.wustl.edu> and <http://gephardtinstitute.wustl.edu>.

### **University Libraries**

WashU Libraries include [seven unique locations](#) across the Danforth Campus, but they are much more than just beautiful, quiet spaces for studying and group work. The Libraries include [librarians for every discipline on campus](#), with the expertise to work with you to develop research ideas and find the best resources to meet your needs; you are also encouraged to explore our [research guides](#), tailored for each subject and available online. The Libraries hold over five million items in the collections—print books, journals, electronic resources, databases, and millions more accessible through interlibrary loan—and you can find it all at [the search on our home page](#). Additional resources for students include special collections, data services, citation help, digital publishing, and more. Visit [the Libraries website](#) for more details about these and other ways that the Libraries are here to support your academic success.